

**Board 1**

North Deals

None Vul

♠ K 9  
 ♥ 10 8 6  
 ♦ K J 9  
 ♣ 8 7 6 3 2

♠ Q J 7 4

♥ A K

♦ 10 8 6 2

♣ A K Q



♠ 10 8 5 2  
 ♥ Q J 9 4 3  
 ♦ Q 4  
 ♣ J 9

♠ A 6 3

♥ 7 5 2

♦ A 7 5 3

♣ 10 5 4

| West     | North | East | South |
|----------|-------|------|-------|
|          | 1♦    | Pass | 2♦    |
| Pass     | 3NT   |      |       |
| All Pass |       |      |       |

3NT by North

and then a small ♠ back toward your ♠ Q J. Here West puts the ♠ K on and you are home-free.

You were a little lucky that West's ♠ K fell on the second round.

If it had not dropped you would just have played a third round of ♠ s, hoping for a 3-3 split in the suit.

Clickagain.

You could also have gotten 3 ♠ winners with this distribution.

North is to play 3NT. East leads the ♥ Q.

Winners: ♠=1 ♥=2 ♦=1 ♣=3 Total = 7

You need two more winners and ♦ s is your longest combined suit. But you can only establish one extra winner in ♦ s, and before you could even do that the defenders would have taken a bunch of ♥ tricks.

So you must turn to the ♠ s for the extra two winners.

You win the first ♥ and lead . . . which ♠? If you play the ♠ Q you will go down, even if East has the ♠ K. He would cover and you would be held to just 2 ♠ tricks.

The only way to get 3 tricks from this holding is to play West for the ♠ K. So play a ♠ to dummy's ♠ A

**Board 3**

North Deals

None Vul

♠ 10 9 6 2

♥ 8 7 6

♦ 7 3

♣ A K 8 2

♠ A 7 5

♥ A J 3

♦ A 8 6

♣ 10 9 6 3



♠ K J 8 4

♥ 10 9 4 2

♦ Q J 10 5

♣ 5

♠ Q 3

♥ K Q 5

♦ K 9 4 2

♣ Q J 7 4

West

North

East

South

1 ♣

Pass

2NT

Pass

3NT

All Pass

3NT by South

The chance of ♦s splitting 3-3 is about 40%.

So you should enter dummy with a ♥ and play a small ♠ toward your ♠Q.

Did it work?

You might have thought of another possibility; duck a ♦, then play ♦A and ♦K to see if the ♦s split before you try leading toward the ♠Q.

The problem is that you might run into this very distribution. You would establish a ♦ for East and when you played a ♠ from dummy East would jump up with the ♠K and cash his winning ♦ for down 1.

South is to play 3NT. West leads the ♣A, then ♣K, ♣2. East follows once, then discards a ♠ and a ♥.

West leads the ♣A, then ♣K, ♣2. East follows once, then discards a ♠ and a ♥.

Winners: ♠=1 ♥=3 ♦=2 ♣=2 Total = 8

There are two possibilities for getting an extra winner. If the ♦s are splitting 3-3 you could play ♦A, ♦K and another ♦ and establish the thirteenth ♦ as a winner. Or you could play East for the ♠K and lead toward your ♠Q.

The chance of East holding the ♠K is a little greater than 50%. (it is higher than the usual 50% because we know he started with only one ♣, giving him more spaces for other cards).

**Board 5**

East Deals

N-S Vul

♠ 10 8 7 6

♥ 10 6 4 2

♦ 8 2

♣ 10 7 3

♠ A Q 5

♥ K J 9

♦ A 10 4

♣ Q J 9 2



♠ K J 3

♥ Q 7 3

♦ K Q J 9 5

♣ 8 4

♠ 9 4 2

♥ A 8 5

♦ 7 6 3

♣ A K 6 5

*West*

*North*

*East*

*South*

1 ♦

Pass

1NT

Pass

Pass

3NT

All Pass

3NT by North